Volume B | Complete Document User Manual

This manual guides preparation and proposed future work. It is not an instruction from PSS, a delegation of authority, a regulatory opinion, or proof of a completed validation.

DECISION LIMIT: Before formal appointment and written authority, do not represent PSS, engage banks as PSS, request internal data, issue RFIs, touch live transactions, or approve expenditure.

How the 18-package programme fits together

Start with the Master Programme Library README_FIRST.md and the Master Control Register. All paths below are relative to PSS_A360_Master_Programme_Library_v1/. Follow the source document control and QA history; this is a reader-and-use manual, not a rewritten source of truth.

Layer	Read order	Decision question
Authority	S04/V01 → S01	Do we have authority to research and a falsifiable problem?
Evidence	S02–S03 → V02–V05	Does a bank face a material cost, and can PSS address it?
Product	P01 → P02 → P03 → P04	What needs to be delivered, by whom and using which sourcing strategy?
Feasibility	F02 → F03 → F04 → F05	Can it be operated lawfully, safely and profitably on both sides?
Decision	F06 → F01	Has independent challenge occurred and what gate, if any, can be authorised?

S01 | Strategic investment thesis and conditional management proposition

Library folder: 01_Strategy_and_Governance/S01

Use it when: Start sponsor conversation; refresh after V03–V05

Procedure: Read S01 after S04; confirm problem statement, buyer, alternatives and excluded regulated operations.

Expected output: Versioned thesis and list of falsifiable claims.

Do not infer: Do not request capital approval based only on public market evidence.

Source documents: S01_Strategic_Investment_Case_PreInvestment_v1.docx

Source Excel file: No dedicated workbook; use Master Register

S02 | Five alternatives and option sensitivity

Library folder: 01_Strategy_and_Governance/S02

Use it when: When comparing proposed solutions

Procedure: Check criteria, hard gates and evidence map; re-score with verified observations; retain BAU/no-build.

Expected output: Option comparison and rationale for changes.

Do not infer: Preference rankings are not investment NPV.

Source documents: S02_Business_Model_and_Strategic_Options_Assessment_v1.docx

Source Excel file: S02_Options_Scoring_and_Evidence_Workbook_v1.xlsx

S03 | Current PSS capability-and-gap hypothesis

Library folder: 01_Strategy_and_Governance/S03

Use it when: During authorised product inventory

Procedure: Read each product claim as provisional; validate with real owner, licence, contract and production evidence.

Expected output: Signed current-state map or open gap.

Do not infer: Do not infer actual technical reuse from PSS public announcements.

Source documents: S03_PSS_Current_State_Capability_and_Gap_Assessment_v1.docx

Source Excel file: No dedicated workbook; use Master Register

S04_V01 | Proposed master mandate and evidence controls

Library folder: 01_Strategy_and_Governance/S04_V01

Use it when: Start before any authorised institutional study

Procedure: Read S04/V01 TOR; after appointment seek written research authority; open Data Requests and Gate Controls.

Expected output: Approved TOR or written refusal; nominated sponsor.

Do not infer: Do not treat an unsigned TOR as a delegation.

Source documents: S04_V01_Master_Research_Validation_Feasibility_TOR.docx

Source Excel file: PSS_A360_Master_Control_and_Evidence_Registers.xlsx

V02 | Market, competitors and bank opportunity hypotheses

Library folder: 02_Research_and_Validation/V02

Use it when: Refresh before buyer sampling and commercial model

Procedure: Confirm source dates and merchant denominators; record any V04 study updates in V02 change register.

Expected output: Evidence-controlled market baseline.

Do not infer: Do not multiply merchant counts by unverified bank tariffs.

Source documents: V02_Market_Competitor_Ecosystem_Opportunity_Assessment_v1.docx

Source Excel file: V02_Market_Evidence_Competitor_Opportunity_Workbook_v1.xlsx

V03 | Bank-buyer discovery and WTP protocol

Library folder: 02_Research_and_Validation/V03

Use it when: After approval for bank outreach

Procedure: Approve outreach/consent; screen buyer role; interview; link buyer proof to pricing and alternatives; log dissent.

Expected output: Consent-qualified bank buyer and budget evidence.

Do not infer: Do not count non-binding enthusiasm as commitment.

Source documents: V03_Bank_Discovery_and_WTP_Validation_Protocol_v1.docx; V03_Bank_Fieldwork_Questionnaires_and_Sponsor_Templates_v1.docx

Source Excel file: V03_Bank_Research_Evidence_Pricing_and_Sponsor_Register_v1.xlsx

V04 | Merchant observations and concept validation

Library folder: 02_Research_and_Validation/V04

Use it when: After approved merchant research design

Procedure: Follow quotas; use script and neutral concepts; code pain points; log refusals and counterexamples.

Expected output: Anonymised observation and concept findings.

Do not infer: Small qualitative sample is not national statistical proof.

Source documents: V04_Merchant_Fieldwork_Instruments_and_Concept_Cards_v1.docx; V04_Merchant_Needs_Usage_and_Concept_Validation_Protocol_v1.docx

Source Excel file: V04_Merchant_Evidence_and_Concept_Validation_Register_v1.xlsx

P01 | Proposed modular service catalogue and testable requirements

Library folder: 03_Product_and_Operating_Design/P01

Use it when: After bank and capability learning begins

Procedure: Review Operate/Connect first; trace every proposed function to owner, value case and acceptance test.

Expected output: Controlled requirements baseline with rejected/deferred features.

Do not infer: A requirements document does not mean feature exists.

Source documents: P01_Product_Requirements_and_Service_Catalogue_v1.docx

Source Excel file: P01_Requirements_Traceability_and_Acceptance_Workbook_v1.xlsx

P02 | Logical interfaces, event-state design and negative tests

Library folder: 03_Product_and_Operating_Design/P02

Use it when: During authorised technical review

Procedure: Review read-only evidence boundary, event contracts, tenancy, reconciliation and disaster-recovery design.

Expected output: Architecture decision record + test traces.

Do not infer: Payment authorisation is not proof of settlement.

Source documents: P02_Solution_Architecture_and_Integration_Blueprint_v1.docx

Source Excel file: P02_Integration_Decision_and_Test_Registers_v1.xlsx

P03 | Target operating model and RACI

Library folder: 03_Product_and_Operating_Design/P03

Use it when: When assigning roles and preparing bank agreements

Procedure: Review responsibility matrix with actual process owners; align complaint, reversals, settlement and cyber duties.

Expected output: Signed or pending responsibility/handoff map.

Do not infer: RACI draft cannot override licence or consumer obligations.

Source documents: P03_Target_Operating_Model_and_Responsibility_Matrix_v1.docx

Source Excel file: P03_Operating_RACI_Service_and_Control_Registers_v1.xlsx

P04 | Build-buy-partner and vendor diligence

Library folder: 03_Product_and_Operating_Design/P04

Use it when: After reuse verification; before procurement

Procedure: Benchmark PSS internal, PSS Trading, vendors, partner and no-build under same gates; use RFI only if authorised.

Expected output: Transparent evaluated sourcing options and documented conflicts.

Do not infer: No vendor recommendation from blank prices.

Source documents: P04_Build_Buy_Partner_Vendor_and_Contracting_Assessment_v1.docx; P04_Vendor_Neutral_RFI_and_Demonstration_Script_v1.docx

Source Excel file: P04_Sourcing_Options_Evidence_TCO_and_Contract_Registers_v1.xlsx

F01 | Final integrated conditional verdict

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F01

Use it when: After all supporting work and independent review

Procedure: Refresh each dimension and evidence gate; include disqualifiers and alternatives; obtain dated management disposition.

Expected output: Reissued signed decision pack or defer/stop record.

Do not infer: Do not turn zero cleared gates into conditional investment approval.

Source documents: F01_Executive_Conditional_Decision_Note_v1.docx; F01_Integrated_Feasibility_Study_and_Conditional_Decision_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F01_Integrated_Evidence_Gates_Options_and_Decision_Workbook_v1.xlsx

F02 | Technical, cyber and certification feasibility

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F02

Use it when: After authorised sandbox/test plan

Procedure: Run change-controlled tests; verify exact certificate scope, PCI MPoC relevance, outage and tenant isolation.

Expected output: Independent technical findings / unresolved defects.

Do not infer: “Technically plausible” is not tested or certified.

Source documents: F02_Technical_Integration_Cybersecurity_Certification_Feasibility_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F02_Technical_Test_Risk_and_Evidence_Registers_v1.xlsx

F03 | Legal, licensing, privacy and contract feasibility

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F03

Use it when: Before any pilot or official data sharing

Procedure: Obtain original licence and current instrument; have legal classify activities and flows; check controller/processor duties.

Expected output: Counsel-reviewed permission and contract map.

Do not infer: Public regulatory summary cannot replace counsel opinion.

Source documents: F03_Counsel_Consultation_and_Contract_Schedules_v1.docx; F03_Regulatory_Legal_Data_Protection_Compliance_Feasibility_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F03_Legal_Obligations_Gates_and_Evidence_Registers_v1.xlsx

F04 | Two-sided bank + PSS economics

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F04

Use it when: After authorised buyer research and Finance data

Procedure: Enter bank baseline, real price ceiling, PSS fixed/variable costs separately; seek both-side positive value.

Expected output: Pricing evidence and signed cost-to-serve assessment.

Do not infer: Potential PSS margin does not establish bank ROI.

Source documents: F04_Bank_Pricing_Discovery_and_ROI_Field_Guide_v1.docx; F04_Commercial_Economic_and_Pricing_Feasibility_Assessment_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F04_Two_Sided_Commercial_Economics_and_Validation_Workbook_v1.xlsx

F05 | Investment appraisal and 60-month model

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F05

Use it when: After CFO-certified costs and bank ramp

Procedure: Complete named finance inputs, 60-month cash, no-bank fixed costs, FX/downside and alternatives; independently reperform.

Expected output: CFO-certified NPV/funding exposure or inconclusive verdict.

Do not infer: Never fill missing numbers with “reasonable” assumptions and call it verified.

Source documents: F05_Executive_Investment_Decision_Note_v1.docx; F05_Financial_Investment_Feasibility_and_Capital_Allocation_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F05_Investment_Model_Options_Stress_and_Approval_Registers_v1.xlsx

F06 | Independent challenge and risk-assurance framework

Library folder: 04_Feasibility_and_Assurance/F06

Use it when: After evidence collection; before investment decision

Procedure: Commission suitably independent reviewers; log exceptions and adverse findings; obtain opinion with scope limitations.

Expected output: Signed independent conclusion or not assessed.

Do not infer: Prepared challenge checklist is not assurance.

Source documents: F06_Independent_Review_Interview_and_Challenge_Kit_v1.docx; F06_Independent_Risk_and_Feasibility_Assurance_Framework_v1.docx

Source Excel file: F06_Independent_Challenge_Risk_Gates_and_Evidence_Registers_v1.xlsx

V05_Notebook | Personal action notebook and PSS product performance validation

Library folder: 05_Joining_and_Execution/V05_Notebook

Use it when: Personal prep now; technical tests after appointed/access

Procedure: Follow personal P/J tasks, V05 data requests and permitted performance tests; keep audit trail.

Expected output: Access-controlled V05 test evidence.

Do not infer: Never enter fabricated production metrics.

Source documents: 01_Personal_Joining_and_Action_Notebook.docx; 02_V05_Product_Performance_PreAccess_Validation_Framework.docx

Source Excel file: 03_Action_and_V05_Evidence_Tracker.xlsx

How a document advances from draft to accepted evidence

1. Locate the original path and note the source document version and date.
2. Record a claim-level question; cite the page/section or workbook sheet/row that contains it.
3. Classify the source as public statement, prepared design, actual bank/PSS evidence, counsel opinion or independent review.
4. Ask for permission and the minimum necessary evidence; use an access-controlled institutional repository after joining.
5. Retest contradictory findings. Update the originating register and downstream F01 crosswalk with a change request.
6. Have the appropriate functional owner review and date the result; do not self-approve a mandatory gate.
7. Issue a new version with superseded reference and hash, leaving the original untouched.

Five strategic alternatives — do not collapse into one

Alternative	Use the documentation to test
A Full suite	Strategic ambition vs unverified acquisition, implementation and certification costs.
B Operate + Connect	Bank-paid operational value and actual PSS reuse vs no-build.
C PSS Pay-led	Real SoftPOS/platform maturity, adoption economics and channel/scheme readiness.
D Partner-led	Specialist provider cost, risk, legal authority, exit and portability.
E BAU / no new platform	Existing product optimisation and no-investment baseline.

Interpretation and audit vocabulary

Status	What to write
Prepared	Research instrument or design exists; activity may be unperformed.
Public claim	Reported by regulator/company/researcher; specify issuer/date/denominator.
Proposed	Concept or assumed responsibility not accepted by PSS/bank.
Unverified	No original institutional proof supplied.
Not assessed	Test/assurance/review has not occurred.
Passed with evidence	Named reviewer, date, test trace and access-controlled locator exist.
Deferred / rejected	Dated decision and owner; retain adverse evidence and alternative.

Source chronology and conflict examples

- The 2026 merchant survey referenced in V04 is an input for updating V02. It cannot be multiplied by unrelated national MSME or banking denominators.
- Statements about PSS Pay or PSS Secure from public publicity must be reconciled with actual deployment and scope rather than promoted to production proof.
- The NBE draft digital payments strategy is not an enacted tariff, subsidy or interchange authority.
- An internal screen showing a successful authorisation does not alone prove reversal reconciliation or settlement.
- No-workflow/no-build may prevail when verified costs or buyer budgets fail the positive-value test.

Manager handoff checklist

- ☐ S04 mandate approved?
- ☐ V03 actual buyer evidence traceable?
- ☐ S03/V05 reuse tests complete?
- ☐ P02/P03 bank/PSS permissions and responsibilities reviewed?
- ☐ F03 original licences and data flows counsel-cleared?
- ☐ F04 both parties positive value under actual inputs?
- ☐ F05 downside and peak funding approved?
- ☐ F06 independent opinion issued?
- ☐ F01 revised outcome signed?